

0.0.1 The Stilling of Thoughts

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Savatthi in Jeta's Grove, Anathapindika's Park. At that place the Auspicious One addressed the bhikkhus: "Bhikkhus." "Bhante," those bhikkhus replied to the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One said this:

2. For a bhikkhu devoted to the higher mind, O bhikkhus, he should pay attention to five signs from time to time. What five?

3. Here, O bhikkhus, for a bhikkhu, whatever sign owing to the attention of which there arises evil, unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should attend to some other sign connected with the wholesome. From his [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

4. Just as, O bhikkhus, a skilled carpenter or a carpenter's apprentice having used a very tiny peg, would knock out a grosser peg. So too, O bhikkhus, for a bhikkhu,

0.0.1 vitakkasaṇṭhānasuttaṃ

1. evaṃ me suttaṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā sāvatthiyaṃ viharati jetavane anāthapiṇḍikassa ārāme. tatra kho bhagavā bhikkhū āmantesi bhikkhavoti. bhaddanteti te bhikkhū bhagavato paccassosum. bhagavā etadavoca:

2. adhiccittamanuyuttena bhikkhave bhikkhunā pañca nimittāni kālana kālaṃ manasikātabbāni. katamāni pañca?

3. idha bhikkhave bhikkhunā yaṃ nimittaṃ āgama yaṃ nimittaṃ manasikaroto uppajjanti pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tamhā nimittā aññaṃ nimittaṃ manasikātabbaṃ kusālūpasamhitam. tassa tamhā nimittā aññaṃ nimittaṃ manasikaroto kusālūpasamhitam, ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti. te abbhatthaṃ gacchanti. tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti¹, samādhīyati.

4. seyyathāpi bhikkhave dakkho palagaṇḍo vā palagaṇḍantevāsī vā sukhumāya āṇiyā oḷārikaṃ āṇiṃ abhinīhaneyya² abhinīhareyya abhinivajjeyya³ evameva kho

¹hosi - machasaṃ

²abhinīhaneyya - machasaṃ

³abhinivatteyya - machasaṃ

whatever sign owing to the attention of which there arises evil, unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should attend to some other sign connected with the wholesome. From his [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

5. If, O bhikkhus, from that bhikkhu's [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should investigate the danger in those thoughts thus: "These thoughts are indeed unwholesome. These thoughts are indeed blameworthy. These thoughts indeed ripen in suffering." Of him investigating the danger of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

bhikkhave bhikkhuno yaṃ nimittam āgama yaṃ nimittam manasikaroto uppajjanti pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tamhā nimittā aññaṃ nimittam manasikātabbam kusalūpasamhitam. ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbattham gacchanti. tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

5. tassa ce bhikkhave bhikkhuno tamhā nimittā aññaṃ nimittam manasikaroto kusalūpasamhitam uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam vitakkānam ādīnavo upaparikkhitabbo: itipime vitakkā akusalā, itipime vitakkā sāvajjā, itipime vitakkā dukkhavipākāti. tassa tesam vitakkānam ādīnavam upaparikkhato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti. te abbattham gacchanti, tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

6. seyyathāpi bhikkhave itthī vā vā puriso vā daharo yuvā maṇḍanakajātiko ahikuṇapena vā kukkurakuṇapena vā manussakuṇapena vā kaṇṭhe āsattena aṭṭiyeyya harāyeyya jiguccheyya, evameva kho bhikkhave tassa ce bhikkhuno tamhāpi⁴ nimittā aññaṃ nimittam

⁴tamhā va - syā

6. Just as, O bhikkhus, a woman or man, young in years, a youth, fond of adornments, would be troubled, humiliated and disgusted at the corpse of a snake, a corpse of a dog, or a corpse of a human being strung around his or her neck. So too, O bhikkhus, if from that bhikkhu's [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should investigate the danger in those thoughts thus: "These thoughts are indeed unwholesome. These thoughts are indeed blameworthy. These thoughts indeed ripen in suffering." Of him investigating the danger of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

7. If, O bhikkhus, for that bhikkhu investigating the danger of those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should engage in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts. Of him engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get

manasikaroto kusalūpasamhitam uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam vitakkānam ādīnavo upaparikkhitabbo: itipime vitakkā akusalā, itipime vitakkā sāvajjā, itipime vitakkā dukkhavipākāti. tassa tesam vitakkānam ādīnavam upaparikkhato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti. te abbhattham gacchanti tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

7. tassa ce bhikkhave bhikkhuno tesam⁵ vitakkānam ādīnavam upaparikkhato uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam⁶ vitakkānam asati amanasikāro āpajjitabbo. tassa tesam vitakkānam asati amanasikāram āpajjato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti. te abbhattham gacchanti. tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

8. seyyathāpi bhikkhave cakkhumā puriso āpāthagatānam rūpānam adassanakāmo assa, so nimīleyya⁷ vā aññena vā apalokeyya. evameva kho bhikkhave tassa ce bhikkhuno tesampi vitakkānam ādīnavam upaparikkhato uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chan-

⁵tesampi - machasam

⁶tesam yeva avi

⁷nimmīleyyā - syā

abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

8. Just as, O bhikkhus, a man endowed with eyes wishing not to see forms that have come into his range would close his eyes or would look elsewhere. So too, O bhikkhus, if for that bhikkhu investigating the danger of those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should engage in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts. Of him engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

9. If, O bhikkhus, for that bhikkhu engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should pay attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts. Of him paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their

dūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāro āpajjitabbo. tassa tesam vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāraṃ āpajjato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi

9. tassa ce bhikkhave bhikkhuno tesampi vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāraṃ āpajjato uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam vitakkānaṃ vitakkasaṅkhārasaṅṭhānaṃ⁸ manasi kātabbaṃ tassa tesam vitakkānaṃ vitakkasaṅkhārasaṅṭhānaṃ manasikaroto ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahiyanti te abbattham gacchanti. tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

10. seyyathāpi bhikkhave puriso sīghaṃ gaccheyya, tassa evamassa: kinnu kho ahaṃ sīghaṃ gacchāmi, yannūnāhaṃ saṇikaṃ gaccheyyanti. so saṇikaṃ gaccheyya. tassa evamassa: kinnu kho ahaṃ saṇikaṃ gacchāmi, yannūnāhaṃ tiṭṭheyyanti. so tiṭṭheyya. tassa evamassa: kinnu kho ahaṃ tṭhito yannūnāhaṃ nisīdeyyanti, so nisīdeyya. tassa evamassa: kinnu kho ahaṃ nisinna, yannūnāhaṃ nipajjeyyanti. so nipajjeyya. evaṃ hi so bhikkhave puriso oḷārikaṃ oḷārikaṃ

⁸vitakka saṅkhāra santhānaṃ - syā. aṭṭhakathā 'tena bhikkhave -pe- mohūpasamhitāpi' pāṭhoyaṃ marammachatṭhasaṅgitipīṭakapotthake na disate ■

abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

10. Just as, O bhikkhus, it might occur to a man moving quickly thus: “Why am I moving quickly? What if I were to move slowly?” While moving slowly it might occur to him thus: “Why am I moving slowly? What if I were to stand still?” While standing still it might occur to him thus: “Why am I standing still? What if I were to sit down?” While sitting down it might occur to him thus: “Why am I sitting down? What if I were to lie down?” Then he lies down. Thus, O bhikkhus, that man having left behind grosser and grosser postures, would fashion subtler and subtler postures. So too, O bhikkhus, if for that bhikkhu engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should pay attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts. Of him paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

11. If, O bhikkhus, for that bhikkhu paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, there still

iriyāpathaṃ abhinivajjetvā⁹ sukhumaṃ sukhumaṃ iri-
yāpathaṃ kappeyya. evameva kho bhikkhave tassa ce
bhikkhuno tesampi vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāraṃ
āpajjato uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandū-
pasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena
bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam vitakkānaṃ vitakkasañ-
khārasañṭhānaṃ manasikātabbaṃ. tassa tesam vitak-
kānaṃ vitakkasañkhārasañṭhānaṃ manasikaroto ye
pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpa-
samhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti te abbhata-
thaṃ gacchanti. tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ
santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

11. tassa ce bhikkhave bhikkhuno tesampi vitakkā-
naṃ vitakkasañkhārasañṭhānaṃ manasikaroto uppaj-
janteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi
dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave
bhikkhunā dante'bhidantamādhāya¹⁰ jivhāya tāluṃ āhacca
cetasā cittaṃ abhiniggaṇhitabbaṃ abhinippīletabbaṃ
abhisantāpetabbaṃ. tassa dante'bhidantamādhāya jiv-
hāya tāluṃ āhacca cetasā cittaṃ abhiniggaṇhato abhi-
nippīlayato abhisantāpayato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā
chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi,
te pahīyanti. te abbhataṃ gacchanti. tesam pahānā
ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti
samādhīyati.

⁹ abhinissajjetvā - syā

¹⁰ dantehi dantamādhāya, bahuṣu. dante + abhidantaṃ + ādhāyāti ṭikāyaṃ
padachedo. danteḥi panettha karaṇattho vutto viya dissati - machasaṃ.
dante'bhidantamādhāyāti heṭṭhā dante uparidantaṃ ṭhapetvā aṭṭhakathā
-siridhammārāma suddhi

arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu, having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, should forcibly restrain, completely crush down, overwhelm mental states with mental states. Of him having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, forcibly restraining, completely crushing down, overwhelming mental states with mental states, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

12. Just as, O bhikkhus, a strong man having siezed a weaker man by the head, or having siezed him by the shoulder, were to forcibly restrain, completely crush, and overwhelm him. So too, O bhikkhus, if for that bhikkhu paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu, having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, should forcibly restrain, completely crush down, overwhelm mental states with mental states. Of him having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, forcibly restraining, completely crushing down, overwhelming

12. seyyathāpi bhikkhave balavā puriso dubbalata-
 raṃ purisaṃ sīsevā gahetvā khandhe vā gahetvā abhi-
 niggaṇheyya abhinippīleyya abhisantāpeyya, evameva
 kho bhikkhave tassa ce bhikkhuno tesampi vitakkā-
 naṃ vitakkasaṅkhārasaṅghānaṃ manasikaroto uppaj-
 janteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi
 dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave
 bhikkhunā dante'bhidantamādhāya jivhāya tāluṃ āhacca
 cetasā cittaṃ abhiniggaṇhato abhinippīlayato abhisan-
 tāpayato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhi-
 tāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti.
 te abbhaththaṃ gacchanti. tesam pahānā ajjhattameva
 cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

13. yato kho bhikkhave bhikkhuno yaṃ nimittaṃ āgama
 yaṃ nimittaṃ manasikaroto uppajjanti pāpakā aku-
 salā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mo-
 hūpasamhitāpi, tassa tamhā nimittā aññaṃ nimittaṃ
 manasikaroto kusālūpasamhitam ye pāpakā akusalā
 vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpa-
 samhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbhaththaṃ gacchanti. te-
 sam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisī-
 datī ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

14. tesampi vitakkānaṃ ādīnavam upaparikkhato ye
 pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpa-
 samhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbhath-
 thaṃ gacchanti tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ san-
 tiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

mental states with mental states, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

13. “From the time, O bhikkhus, for a bhikkhu, whatever sign owing to the attention of which there arises evil, unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, that bhikkhu [withdrawing] from that sign, attending to some other sign connected with the wholesome, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

14. also of him investigating the danger of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

15. also of him engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and

15. tesampi vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāraṃ āpajjato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbhatthaṃ gacchanti tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

16. tesampi vitakkānaṃ vitakkasaṅkhārasanthānaṃ manasikaroto ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbhatthaṃ gacchanti tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

17. dante'bhidantamādhāya¹¹ jivahāya tāluṃ āhacca cetasā cittaṃ abhiniggaṇhato abhinippīlayato abhisantāpayato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbhatthaṃ gacchanti tesam pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

18. ayaṃ vuccati bhikkhave bhikkhu vasī vitakkapariyāyapathesu: yaṃ vitakkaṃ ākaṅkhissati taṃ vitakkaṃ vitakkessati, yaṃ vitakkaṃ nākaṅkhissati na taṃ vitakkaṃ vitakkessati, acchechchi taṇhaṃ, vāvattayi¹² saṃyojanaṃ, sammā mānābhisamayā antamakāsi dukkhassāti.

¹¹dantehi dantamādhāya - syā, machasaṃ ■

¹²vivantayi - machasaṃ ■

disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

16. also of him paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

17. also of him having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, should forcibly restraining, completely crushing down, overwhelming mental states with mental states, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

18. this is called, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu who is the master of the pathways of thoughts. Whichever thoughts he wishes to think, it is just those thoughts that he thinks. Whichever thoughts he does not wish to think, it is just those thoughts that he does not think. He has utterly severed thirsting, disjoined the fetters, and rightly breaking through to conceit, has made an end of suffering.”

19. idamavoca bhagavā. attamanā te bhikkhū bhagavato bhāsitam abhinanduntī.

19. This is what the Auspicious One said. Delighted, those bhikkhus rejoiced in the Auspicious One's words.

